The Vilamoura OC

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BDT 2005 · Vilamoura · Featuring Marshy

Written for the 2026 countdown to BDT 2026 in Scottsdale



Bar Nautico

The space outside Bar Nautico in The Old Village, Vilamoura, has become part of tour folklore as it witnessed one of, if perhaps not the most rancorous session in tour history. It was the scene of the OC for BDT 2005 and it was not so much the drinking that was memorably punchy (although we definitely gave it a good tilt that day / night) but more so the handicap session that took place that evening.

Back in those days, rather than issuing handicaps "Stalin-style" we would venture on tour with no set handicaps and invite each Dog to put forward to the group his own handicap for consideration at the OC. Needless to say, some lads were targeted mercilessly – in part dependent upon which team the Dog in question happened to be on – if he was on the opposition team, basically you went for him, no holds barred!

This inevitably led to a huge amount of unseemly squabbling as some tourists were visibly upset to be dispensed with handicaps a good six shots under their proposals whilst, in their view, others had got away remarkably lightly!

The sense of injustice carried on for some for the rest of the evening, if not the entire tour, and it probably says it all that never since have we had a live handicap-committee session!

One other memory stands out head and shoulders above all others from this evening.

With handicaps duly allocated, three quarters of the way through the subsequent fines session Marshy had been presented with a fine for some misdemeanour or other. Two fingers was the fine.

Marshy picked up the nearest bottle of Mateus and so was born an unforgettable tour moment!



▶ **Watch:** Marsh v Mateus





After the Rosé

